Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Chip Patina

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Chip Patina

Chief Conservator

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects safe from humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. He is the bedrock of this museum and he knows it.

- Works with **Claire O'Scuro** on the care and display of the collection.
- Argues with **Dr. Art E. Fact** about what the physical evidence can actually prove.
- Advises **Elle Loominate** on displaying fragile textiles. **Elle** listens, then asks for a less ugly support.

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, slightly territorial. You care more about what is best for this institution than what is socially convenient.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Chip Patina. Please admire the art without touching it. That includes touching it to demonstrate that you are not touching it.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Chip Patina

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Care is how he expresses affection. He can discuss a centuries-old crack more easily than guilt or grief.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Chip Patina

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Black and white keys make music. Their underside keeps quieter company.*

2 *Take a paper journey to the city of Gaudí; your reward rests on its map.*

3 *Important information can be found in the coldest room that fits inside a kitchen.*

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He liked my name beneath his description. We had already argued over treatment paperwork. Then the entrance mount started moving. People sighed when I stopped the conversation. They always do. I am easier company if nobody touches anything. Claire knows that. Tonight I was exceptionally poor company.

IF MURDERER

> Recent repair. Grant wanted me to call it ancient. He had the insurance copy with the date I altered. Refusing his description meant answering for mine. Then the entrance mount started moving. He suggested I was inventing another problem to protect myself. Claire knows how I am about handling. Grant knew how to turn that into a joke.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I fitted the red band before the preview. Kept the condition sheet. Grant waved the insurance copy at me and asked what my signature was worth. That date wasn't a change I authorized. Then Frank's mount moved. Finally, something I could fix with my hands. Frank, get the load down. I'll discuss your feelings about my tone afterward.

IF MURDERER

I fitted the red band before the preview and kept the condition sheet. The copy with my false date was still at the workbench. After the preview I went to Grant's place to ask for that copy back. He wasn't there. The glass was. I held it up to the light: a shop engraving isn't a condition report. Put it back. Then Frank's mount started moving and I went to the alcove. Frank, I wanted that load down. The paper could wait. I told myself it could wait.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Chip Patina

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Foil-backed paper. Red face, silver back. I fitted it across the stopper. Inspected the front. Missed the split behind. The insurance date is a copying error. I didn't alter it. No, Barb, leave the supply sleeve where it is. Photograph the stock before you touch it. There are enough people deciding what happened at my workbench.

IF MURDERER

> My closure band was red woven tape. Foil-backed paper was packaging stock. The sleeve and technician's photograph concerned the band work. They weren't an inventory of every red scrap in the museum. The insurance date is wrong. I changed it. I can answer that question. I will not identify somebody else's packaging as a material I used.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

BALLOT

Chip Patina

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

Chip Patina

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't poison Grant. My band was foil-backed paper. I missed the split behind it. I changed the insurance date myself, and then called it a copying error. Grant had that copy. I wanted you examining the paper instead of the person who signed it. Claire, the workbench can be packed now. Photograph every piece. I don't expect my word to do the job.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The red band was foil-backed paper, exactly as the report says. I denied my own material because I had opened the bottle during the preview. I knew where its closure was weakest. Later I put the stolen poison in Grant's private glass. Its scrap and the damaged band belong to that sequence; they are not a unique fingerprint, and I hoped you would stop at that objection. The false date gave him leverage over me. I used the weakness in a closure I had fitted. People trusted my hands near things that could not be replaced. They should never trust them again.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.